GG-C-1213A
February 23, 1977
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. GG-C-001213(DSA-DM)
September 21, 1967

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

CURETTE, EAR, BILLEAU

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Services, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. Curettes covered by this specification are for surgical use in scraping the exterior ear to clean its surface, to obtain material for diagnostic purposes, or to remove a lesion or foreign body.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

GG-I-526	-	Instruments, Dental and Surgical; General Specifications.
PPP-B-566	-	Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-585	-	Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-601	-	Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621	-	Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676	-	Boxes, Setup.

FSC 6515

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Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies)
Fed. Std. No. 151 - Metals, Test Methods.

(Those outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards as stated in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards. The Index, including cumulative supplements issued during the year, is sold on subscription by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required for bidding purposes are available from the General Services Administration Business Service Centers in Boston, New York, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles and Seattle, or from the General Services Administration, Specification Sales, Bldg. 197, Washington Navy Yard, Washington, DC 20407.)

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL-P-116	-	Preservation-Packaging, Methods of.
MIL-L-10547	-	Liners, Case and Sheet, Overwrap, Water-Vaporproof, or Waterproof, Flexible.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

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2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Standard:

E-18	-	Rockwell Hardness and Rockwell Superficial Hardness of Metallic Materials.
E-92	-	Method of Test for Vickers Hardness of Metallic Materials.
E-140	-	Standard Hardness Conversion Tables for Metals (Relationship between Brinell Hardness, Vickers Hardness, Rockwell Hardness, Rockwell Superficial Hardness and Knoop Hardness).

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association Incorporated, Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Association, Inc., ATTN: Traffic Department, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 General requirements. The individual part requirements shall be as specified herein and in accordance with the applicable requirement of GG-I-526. In the event of a conflict between the requirements of GG-I-526 and those of this specification, the latter shall govern.

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3.2 Materials. Materials shall be as specified herein (see table I) and in accordance with the applicable requirements of GG-I-526.

TABLE I. Material

Component	Material	AISI Type	Hardness
Handle and shank	Steel, stainless	300 series 1/ 420	B100 Max C40-45
Handle		416 2/	B85-100
Shank		420	3/
Loop		300 series 4/ 420	B75-85 C40-C45

1/ AISI Type 301, 302 or 303.
2/ Except chemical composition may vary as follows: Carbon-0.17% max; Chromium - 12.00 - 17.50%, and Manganese - 1.5% max.
3/ Not hardened.
4/ AISI Type 301, 302, 303 or 304.

3.3 Design and construction. Curettes shall be of the design, construction and physical dimensions specified herein and suitable for use in curettage of the exterior ear.

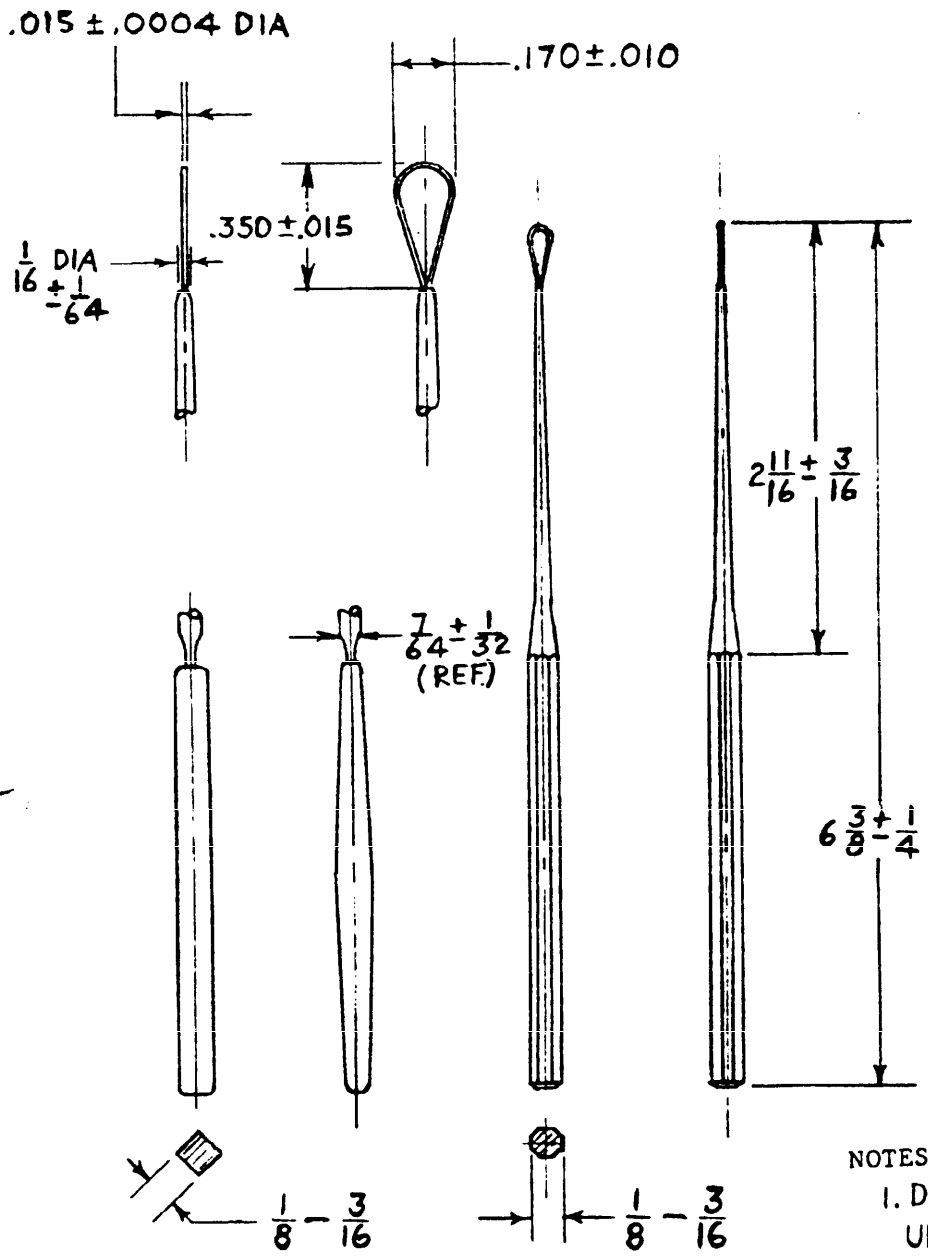
3.3.1 Billeau ear curette. The ear curette shall be of the Billeau design, with a flexible, oval shaped, medium size ear loop which shall be securely attached to the shank.

3.3.1.1 Handle and shank. The handle and shank shall be fabricated as a single component or may be designed as a two piece assembly, with a solid or hollow handle. When constructed of more than one piece the shank shall be securely attached to the handle.

3.3.1.2 Loop. The loop shall be securely and firmly attached to the shank. Where the loop enters the shank there shall be no crevice or space where foreign material may collect or which may be subject to corrosion.

3.3.2 Physical dimensions and configuration. The physical dimensions and configuration shall be in accordance with figure 1. The alternate design is delineated in figure 2.

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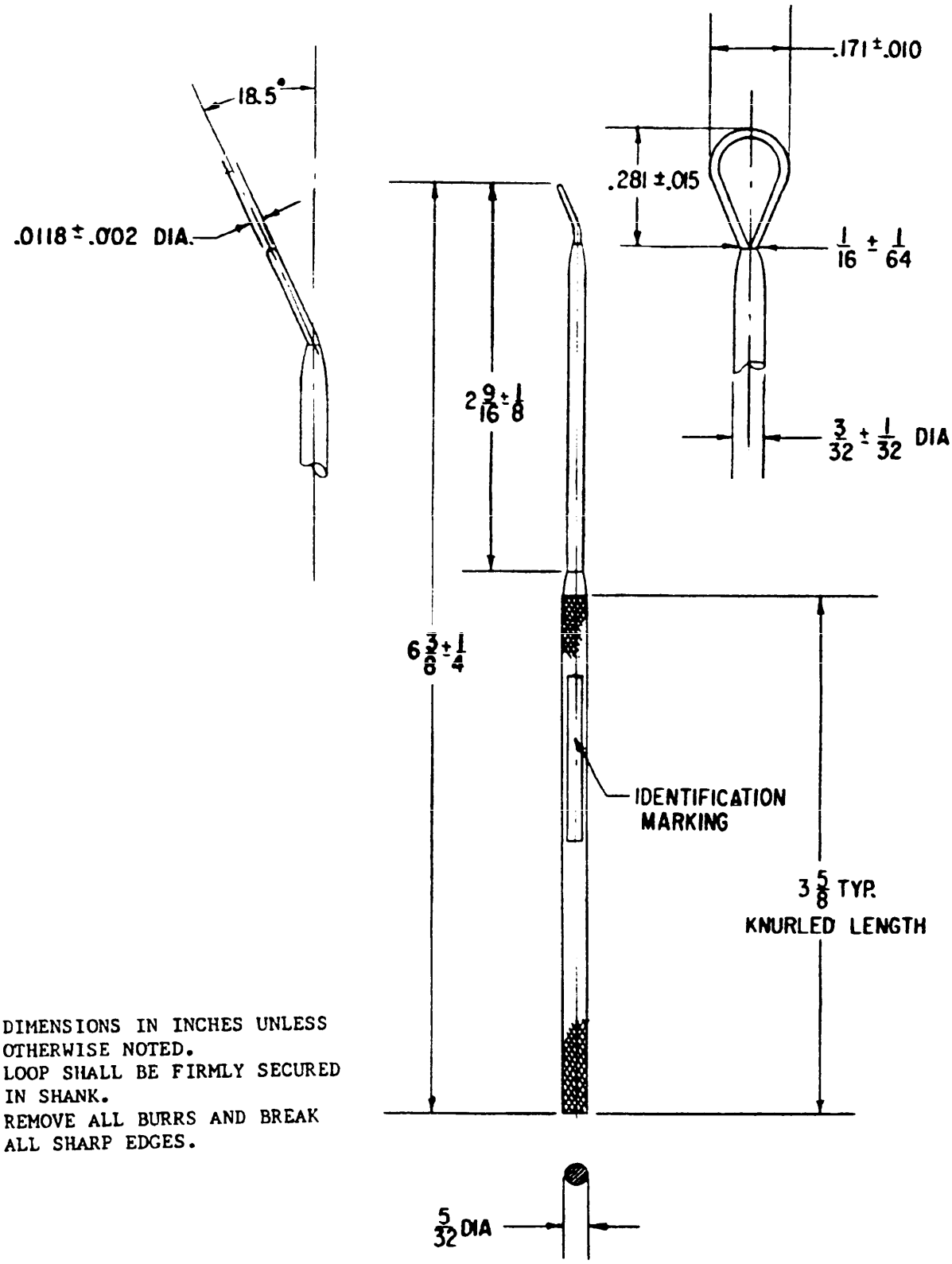
ALTERNATE HANDLE CONFIGURATION

NOTES:
1. DIMENSIONS IN INCHES UNLESS OTHERWISE NOTED
2. LOOP SHALL BE FIRMLY SECURED IN SHANK
3. REMOVE BURRS & BREAK ALL SHARP EDGES

FIGURE 1. Curette, ear, Billeau, medium.

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ALTERNATE DESIGN



NOTES:

1. DIMENSIONS IN INCHES UNLESS OTHERWISE NOTED.
2. LOOP SHALL BE FIRMLY SECURED IN SHANK.
3. REMOVE ALL BURRS AND BREAK ALL SHARP EDGES.

FIGURE 2. Curette, ear, Billeau, medium.

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3.3.3 Hardness. The Rockwell hardness of the finished instrument or the component parts of the finished instrument shall be as specified in table I when tested as specified in 4.5.1.

3.3.4 Corrosion resistance. The instrument shall be corrosion resistant conforming with the requirements of GG-I-526 when tested as specified in 4.5.2.1 and 4.5.2.2.

3.4 Finish. The finished instrument shall have a mirror finish in accordance with GG-I-526. If the instrument is constructed of more than one piece, the pieces shall be permanently joined together and all seams shall be smooth and sealed on all sides.

3.4.1 Passivation. As a final finish operation instrument parts fabricated from Type 300 or 400 series materials shall be passivated.

3.5 Size designation. Size designation shall be stamped on the handle.

3.6 Identification marking. Identification marking of finished instruments shall be in accordance with the requirements of GG-I-526. In addition, instruments of foreign manufacture shall also be marked "stainless".

3.7 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. The instrument shall be processed in such a manner as to be uniform in quality and shall be free from defects that will affect life, serviceability or appearance.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

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4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.3 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the corrosion-resistant metals may be furnished in lieu of actural performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the National Stock Number (NSN), the item identification, the name of the component/material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Inspection lot. The inspection lot shall be determined in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.2.2 Preparation for delivery. The inspection lot size shall be expressed in units of one fully prepared shipping container, containing complete instruments fully prepared for delivery and made from essentially the same materials and components. The sample unit shall be one fully prepared shipping container, containing instruments fully prepared for delivery, with the exception that it need not be sealed. The inspection shall be Inspection Level S-2 and Acceptable Quality Level shall be 4.0 percent defective in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

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4.2.3 Sampling for visual and dimensional examination. A random sample of curettes shall be selected from each lot offered to the Government in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The Acceptable Quality Levels (AQL's) shall be as indicated in table II. The unit of product shall be one curette.

TABLE II. Sampling for examination.

Type defect	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective
Major A	II	1.0
Major B	S-4	1.0
Minor A	II	4.0
Minor B	S-2	4.0

4.2.4 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, and as indicated in table III. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics. Unless otherwise specified, the unit of product for tests shall be one curette.

TABLE III. Sampling criteria for tests.

Component	Characteristic	Requirement	procedure	Inspection level	AQL
Curette	Rockwell hardness	3.3.3	4.5.1	S-2	1.5
	Corrosion resistance	3.3.4	4.5.2.1& 4.5.2.2	S-2	1.5

4.2.5 Raw materials. A sufficient amount from each lot of each metal used in the construction of the instrument shall be selected for chemical analysis.

4.3 Examination for visual and dimensional defects. The instrument shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification. Examination shall be conducted as specified in tables II and IV. Examination, however, shall not be restricted to defects listed in table IV. Any instrument in the sample containing one or more defects shall be rejected and if the number of defective instruments in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by that sample shall be rejected.

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TABLE IV. Classification of defects.

Categories	Defects
Critical	None defined.
Major A	
101	Operative end design not as specified.
102	Instrument not free from sharp edges, rough areas, burrs, cracks, grind marks and overlaps.
103	Operative end improperly shaped or not as specified.
Major B	
151	Loop dimensions not as specified.
152	Crevice or space where loop joins shank.
153	Shank and handle design not as specified.
Minor	
201	Finish not as specified.
202	Size designation not permanently and legibly marked or missing.
203	Identification marking missing or not permanently and legibly marked.
Minor B	
251	Handle and shank dimensions not as specified.

4.4 Examination of preparation for delivery. Each of the fully prepared shipping containers, containing instruments, selected as a sample unit from the lot shall be visually examined to determine that the packaging, packing and marking conform to this specification. The classification of defects, table V, shall be used to classify the defects found.

TABLE V. Examination of preparation for delivery.

Examine	Defect
Contents	Not as specified
Container	Not as specified.
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence or method of application.
Material	Component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Buldging or distortion of containers.

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4.4.1 Examination of closure, waterproofing and banding of containers. When the shipping container is required to comply with PPP-B-636, the examination for defects in closure, waterproofing or banding shall be in accordance with the appendix of the box specification.

4.5 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.5.1 Hardness. Rockwell hardness shall be determined in accordance with ASTM test method E18. A minimum of 5 hardness readings shall be made on test specimens representative of the material used in the fabrication of the instrument, or on the finished instrument.

4.5.2 Corrosion tests.

4.5.2.1 Boil test. The instruments shall be subjected to the boil test specified in GG-I-526.

4.5.2.2 Copper-sulfate test. Instruments fabricated from corrosion resistant steel shall be subjected to the copper sulfate test in accordance with the requirement of GG-I-526.

4.5.3 Composition analysis. Specimens of materials used to fabricate the instrument or taken from the sample shall be subjected to analysis with methods 111.2 or 112.2 of Fed. Std. No. 151.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Unit package. Each curette of the type specified shall be thoroughly cleaned and dried in accordance with the applicable method in MIL-P-116. Each curette shall be wrapped in neutral tissue or other noncorrosive material and packaged in accordance with MIL-P-116, method IC-2. A preservative shall not be applied to the curette.

5.1.1.2 Intermediate package. Twelve unit packages containing curettes shall be packaged in a box constructed in accordance with PPP-B-676. Closure of the box shall be adequate to prevent accidental opening.

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5.1.2 Level C. Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A. Forty eight intermediate packages (576 units) containing currettes shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 3, style 3; PPP-B-601 overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2; or PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. Closure and strapping shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.2.1.1 Case liner. Each Level A Wood box shall be lined with a waterproof case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547. Closure and sealing shall conform to applicable paragraphs of appendix thereto. Case liner shall not be required for fiberboard boxes. Each fiberboard box shall be waterproofed as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B. Forty eight intermediate packages (576 units) containing curettes shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 1, style 3; PPP-B-601, domestic type; PPP-B-621, class 1; or PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. Marking for shipment shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military agencies.

5.3.2.1 Interior packages. Each unit package and each intermediate package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. When labels are utilized, waterproofing shall be required only when applicable carton is fabricated of water-resistant material. Contract or purchase order number and name of contractor shall be shown.

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5.3.2.2 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) National Stock Number.
(c) Applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(d) Marking requirements (see 5.3)

6.2 This specification is intended to cover the following item appearing in the Federal Supply Catalog:

National Stock Number	Item Identification
6515-00-322-0770	CURETTE, EAR, BILLEAU, Medium

6.3 This specification does not cover all types, classes, grades, or sizes of the commodity indicated by the title of this specification, or those which are commercially available, but is intended to cover the types which are no mally procured to meet requirements,

6.4 Military requirements. Military requirements shall apply to all instruments purchased by military agencies. Where applicable, military requirements shall be in addition to all other requirements.

MILITARY CUSTODIANS:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
DSA-DM
Civil Agency Coordinating Activities:
GSA-FSS
VA -DMS
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Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Service Services Administration, acting as agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See section 2 of this specification to obtain copies of documents referenced herein. Price 35 cents each.

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE

GG-C-1213A CURETTE, EAR, BILLEAU

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES.

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

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☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

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